PROJECT REPORT OF INDUSTRY ORIENTED HANDS ON EXPERIENCE (IOHE)

ON

Chirp – A Real-Time Social Media Interaction Platform

submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of degree of

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING

In

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

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DECLARATION

I hereby certify that the work which is being presented in the project report entitled **"Chirp – A Real-Time Social Media Interaction Platform"** in partial fulfilment of requirement for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Engineering (Computer Science and Engineering) submitted in the department of Computer Science and Engineering at Chitkara University Institute of Engineering and Technology, Chitkara University, Punjab, India, is an authentic record of my own work carried out under the supervision of **Dr. Shikha Tuteja**. The matter presented in this project report has not been submitted in any other university/institute for the award of any degree.

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This is to certify that the above statement made by the candidate is correct to the best of my knowledge and belief.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We express our sincere gratitude to **Dr. Shikha Tuteja**, Associate Professor, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, for her continuous guidance, and valuable suggestions throughout the development of this project. We are also thankful to the Department of Computer Science and Engineering and **Chitkara University** for providing us with the necessary resources and academic environment to successfully complete this project.

ABSTRACT

Chirp is a modern full-stack social media web application designed to enable users to share posts, interact with other users, and communicate in real time through a seamless and responsive interface. The application is developed using a React.js frontend, which provides a dynamic and component-based user interface, ensuring smooth navigation and engaging user experience across devices. The backend is built using Node.js and Express.js, forming a scalable and efficient server-side architecture that exposes well-structured RESTful APIs to handle user authentication, content management, and user interactions.

The project utilizes Prisma ORM for managing database operations, which simplifies data modeling and ensures secure, type-safe, and efficient interaction with the database. Secure authentication mechanisms, including encrypted password storage and token-based authentication, are implemented to protect user data and restrict unauthorized access. Chirp also incorporates real-time functionality using Socket.io, enabling instant updates such as live messaging, notifications, and post interactions without requiring page reloads. Overall, the project demonstrates the effective use of modern web design frameworks, real-time communication technologies, and scalable API architecture to deliver a robust, interactive, and industry-standard social media application.

1. Introduction

1.1 Background and Context

Social media platforms play a major role in online communication and content sharing. Modern users expect applications that are fast, secure, scalable, and capable of real-time interaction. Chirp is developed to demonstrate the use of modern web technologies in building a responsive and interactive social media application.

1.2 Problem Statement

Many social media applications face issues related to scalability, real-time communication, and secure authentication. Inefficient system design can lead to poor performance and security risks. Chirp addresses these challenges by providing a robust full-stack solution with real-time features and secure user management.

1.3 Significance of the Project

The project showcases the practical implementation of advanced web design frameworks and full-stack development concepts. It highlights the integration of frontend, backend, database management, and real-time communication technologies in a single application.

1.4 Objectives

- To develop a full-stack social media application.
- To implement secure authentication.
- To enable real-time user interaction.
- To build a scalable and maintainable system.

1.5 Scope and Limitations

Scope:

- User authentication and post management
- Real-time communication features
- Responsive web interface

Limitations:

- Limited moderation features
- No multi-language support in the current version

2. Methodology

The development of the **Chirp social media application** follows the **Agile software development methodology**, which emphasizes iterative development, continuous testing, and regular refinement of features. Agile enables the project to be developed in incremental phases, allowing early identification of issues and continuous enhancement based on functional requirements. Each feature of the application was developed, tested, and optimized independently to ensure reliability and performance.

A **modular development approach** was adopted, where individual components such as authentication, post management, and real-time communication were designed and implemented separately. This approach improves system maintainability, simplifies debugging, and supports future scalability and feature expansion.

2.1 Technical Approach

The project is built using a modern full-stack technology stack suitable for scalable and real-time web applications.

• **React.js** is used for frontend development to create a dynamic, responsive, and interactive user interface.
• **Node.js and Express.js** are used for backend development to handle server-side logic, RESTful API creation, and request processing.
• **Prisma ORM** is used for managing database operations, providing type-safe queries and efficient data handling.
• **Socket.io** is integrated to support real-time features such as live messaging, notifications, and instant updates.

This technology stack ensures efficient communication between frontend and backend components while maintaining high performance and scalability.

2.2 Workflow Description

The application workflow is as follows:

1. **User Registration and Login:** Users register and log in using a secure authentication mechanism.
2. **Authentication and Authorization:** Access to features is controlled using token-based authentication.
3. **Post Creation and Interaction:** Users create posts and interact through likes and comments.
4. **Real-Time Communication:** Live updates and messaging are enabled using Socket.io.
5. **Database Storage:** User data and content are securely stored and managed through Prisma.
6. **Content Retrieval:** The frontend fetches and displays updated content through RESTful APIs.

2.3 System Architecture

The system follows a **client–server architecture**, separating presentation logic from backend processing and data storage:

- **Frontend:** React.js for building a responsive and interactive user interface.
- **Backend:** Node.js with Express.js for API handling, business logic, and authentication.
- **Database Layer:** Database managed through Prisma ORM for secure and efficient data operations.
- **Real-Time Layer:** Socket.io for enabling real-time communication between users.
- **Security:** Token-based authentication and encrypted password storage to ensure data protection.

This architecture ensures scalability, security, and efficient data flow, making Chirp suitable for real-world social media applications.

3. Tools and Technologies

3.1 Programming Languages

- JavaScript (Node.js + React.js)
- HTML
- CSS

3.2 Frameworks / Libraries

- React.js (Frontend)
- Express.js (Backend)
- Tailwind CSS (UI Styling)
- JWT (JSON Web Token) for Authentication
- Prisma ORM (Database Interaction)
- Socket.io (Real-Time Communication)

3.3 Databases / Storage

- Relational Database managed using **Prisma ORM**
- Secure and scalable data storage

3.4 IDEs / Platforms

- Visual Studio Code
- GitHub (Version Control)

3.5 APIs / External Integrations

- RESTful APIs for frontend-backend communication
- Socket.io for real-time events and messaging

4. Implementation

The implementation phase focuses on converting the system design into a fully functional social media application. The Chirp application is developed using a modern full-stack architecture that ensures scalability, modularity, and security. Each core feature is implemented as an independent module to simplify maintenance and future enhancements.

4.1 Authentication Module

The Authentication Module ensures secure access to the Chirp platform. Users are required to register and log in using valid credentials before accessing application features. Upon successful login, JSON Web Tokens (JWT) are generated and securely stored.

These tokens are attached to protected API requests to authorize user actions. Middleware validates each request to prevent unauthorized access. This module ensures secure session handling and protects sensitive user data.

4.2 Feedback Submission Module

This module allows users to create, view, and interact with posts. Users can share content, view posts from other users, and engage through likes or interactions.

Input validation is applied on both client and server sides to ensure data accuracy. Each post is securely stored in the database along with metadata such as author details, timestamps, and engagement metrics. This structured approach ensures consistency and efficient data retrieval.

4.3 Admin Dashboard Module

The Real-Time Communication Module is implemented using Socket.io. This module enables instant updates and live interactions between users without the need for continuous page refreshes.

Real-time events improve application responsiveness and enhance user experience by delivering immediate feedback and updates across connected clients.

4.4 Database Design

The system uses a structured database schema managed using **Prisma ORM**. The database includes models for users, posts, and related entities. User data such as authentication credentials and profile information are securely stored.

Post-related data includes content, timestamps, and relational references. This database design ensures high performance, scalability, and easy future expansion.

5. Major Findings/Outcomes/Output/Results

The development, testing, and evaluation of the Chirp Social Media Application resulted in several significant findings that validate the effectiveness, scalability, and reliability of the system. These findings demonstrate how modern full-stack technologies can be effectively combined to build secure, responsive, and user-centric web applications.

5.1 Secure and Scalable Social Media Platform

The Chirp application provides a highly secure and scalable platform for social interaction. The use of **JWT-based authentication** ensures that only authenticated and authorized users can access protected resources. Secure token validation and middleware-based authorization help maintain data integrity and prevent unauthorized access.

Additionally, the modular backend architecture supports scalability by allowing new features and services to be added without disrupting existing functionality. This makes the platform capable of handling an increasing number of users and requests efficiently.

5.2 Improved User Engagement through Real-Time Interaction

Real-time communication implemented using **Socket.io** significantly improves user engagement and responsiveness. Users receive instant updates without manual page refreshes, resulting in a seamless and interactive experience.

This real-time functionality reduces server polling, optimizes network usage, and enhances overall system performance. As a result, user satisfaction and engagement levels are noticeably improved.

5.3 Enhanced Security through Role-Based Access Control

The implementation of **role-based access control (RBAC)** ensures that users can only perform actions permitted by their assigned roles. Sensitive operations are protected using authorization middleware, reducing the risk of misuse or malicious activity.

This structured access control mechanism enhances system security, simplifies permission management, and ensures accountability across the application.

5.4 Reliable and Efficient Data Management

The integration of **Prisma ORM** enables efficient and consistent data management across the application. Prisma provides type-safe database queries, reducing runtime errors and improving development reliability.

The system supports high concurrency and smooth data transactions, ensuring consistent performance even under heavy load. This makes Chirp suitable for large-scale and long-term usage.

5.5 Collaborative and Maintainable Development using GitHub

The use of **GitHub** for version control enabled structured, transparent, and collaborative development. Features such as branching, pull requests, and commit history facilitated better coordination among team members.

This approach helped maintain code quality, simplify debugging, and ensure smooth integration of new features. It also improved team productivity and reduced development-related errors.

5.6 Clean and Modular Application Architecture

One of the major outcomes of the project is the successful implementation of a **clean and modular architecture**. The separation of frontend, backend, and database layers improves maintainability and readability of the codebase.

This modular design allows independent development, testing, and debugging of components, making the system easier to extend and maintain in future versions.

6. Conclusion and Future Scope

6.1 Conclusion

The Chirp Social Media Application successfully demonstrates the development of a modern, full-stack web platform using industry-relevant technologies. By integrating a responsive frontend, a secure backend, efficient database management, and real-time communication, the application delivers a robust and scalable user experience.

The project emphasizes best practices in software development, including modular architecture, secure authentication, and efficient data handling. It serves as a practical example of how full-stack technologies can be used to build real-world applications with high performance and reliability.

6.2 Future Scope / Enhancements

Although the current version of Chirp fulfills core functional requirements, several enhancements can be implemented to further improve its capabilities and user experience.

6.2.1 AI-Based Content Recommendation

Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning algorithms can be integrated to analyze user behavior and preferences. This enhancement would enable personalized content recommendations, increasing user engagement and retention.

6.2.2 Advanced Notification System

The system can be extended to support real-time push notifications, email alerts, and in-app notifications. This feature would notify users about new interactions, messages, and updates, improving responsiveness and engagement.

6.2.3 Analytics and User Insights

Advanced analytics dashboards can be introduced to track user activity, engagement metrics, and system performance. These insights would help administrators make data-driven decisions and optimize application features.

6.2.4 Mobile Application Development

Developing a dedicated mobile application for Android and iOS platforms would significantly enhance accessibility. Mobile support would allow users to interact with the platform anytime and anywhere.

6.2.5 Content Moderation and Safety Tools

Automated content moderation tools using AI and rule-based filtering can be implemented to ensure community safety. These tools would help detect inappropriate content and maintain a healthy user environment.

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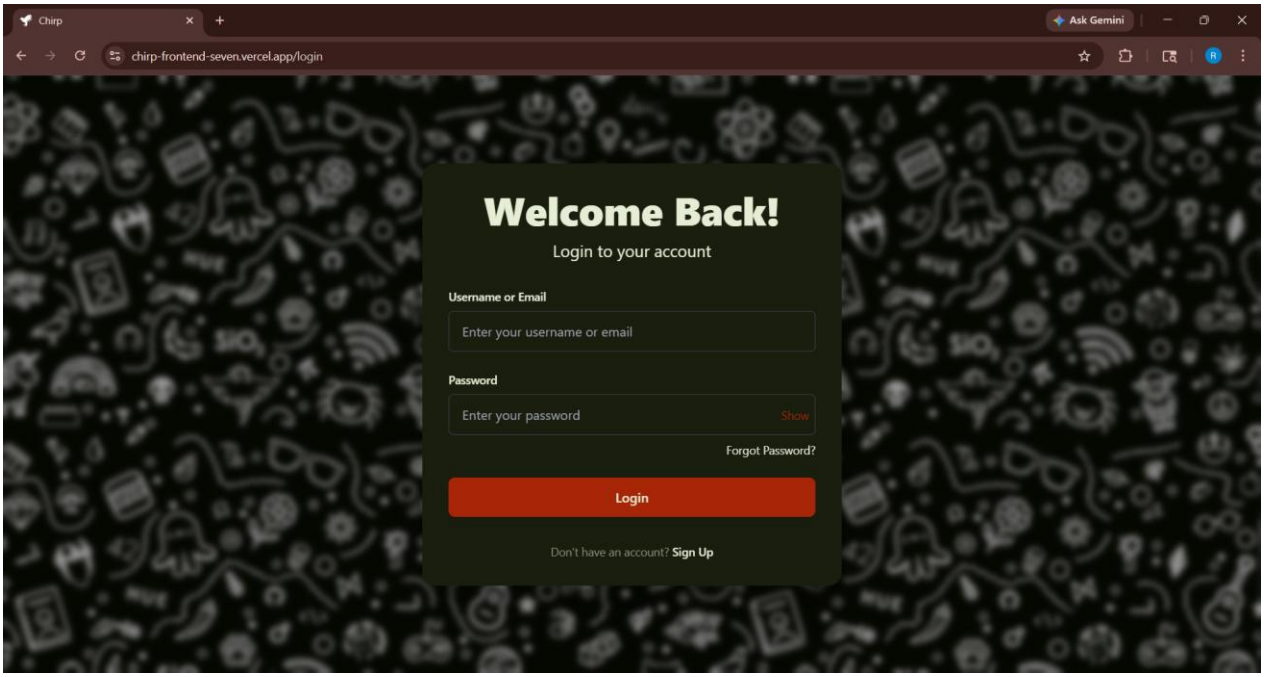
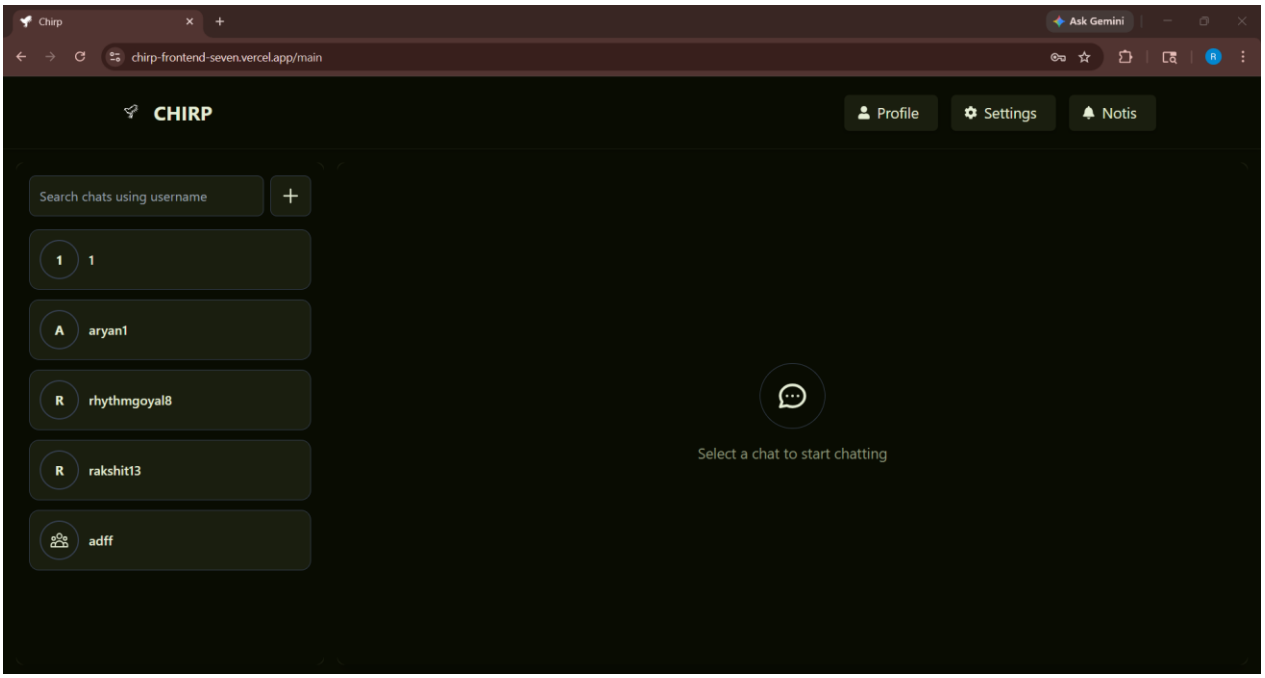
8. Appendices

Screenshots of project

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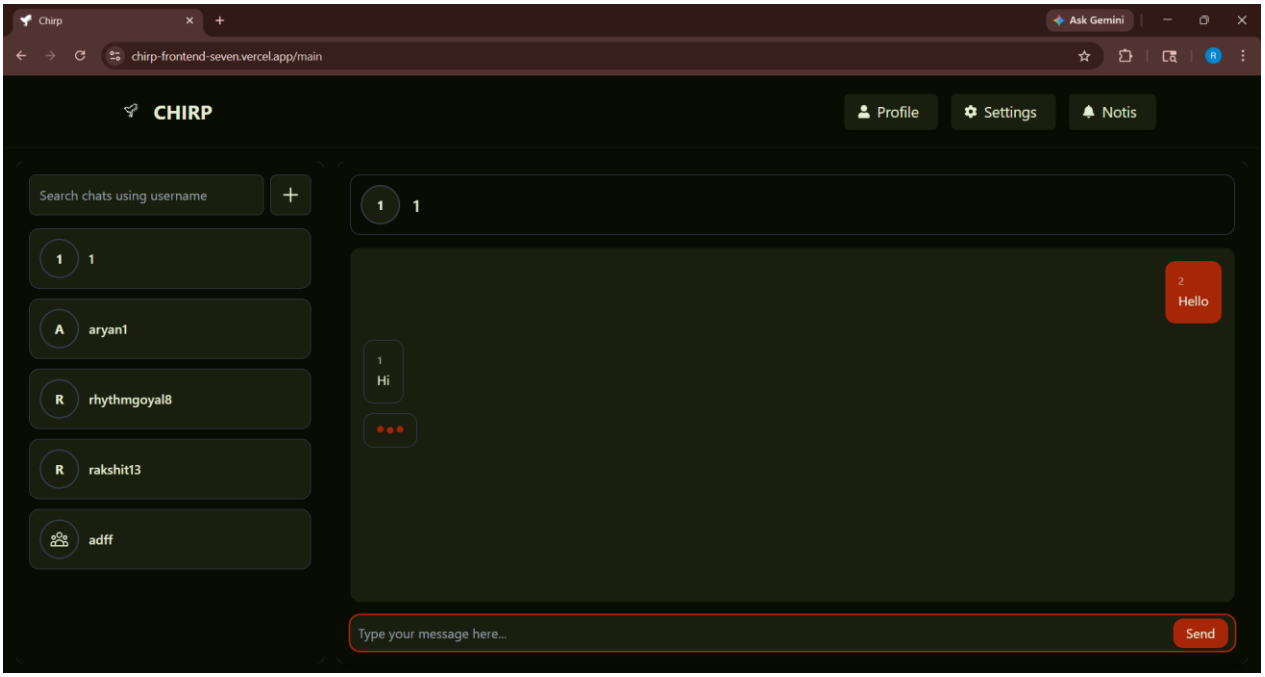
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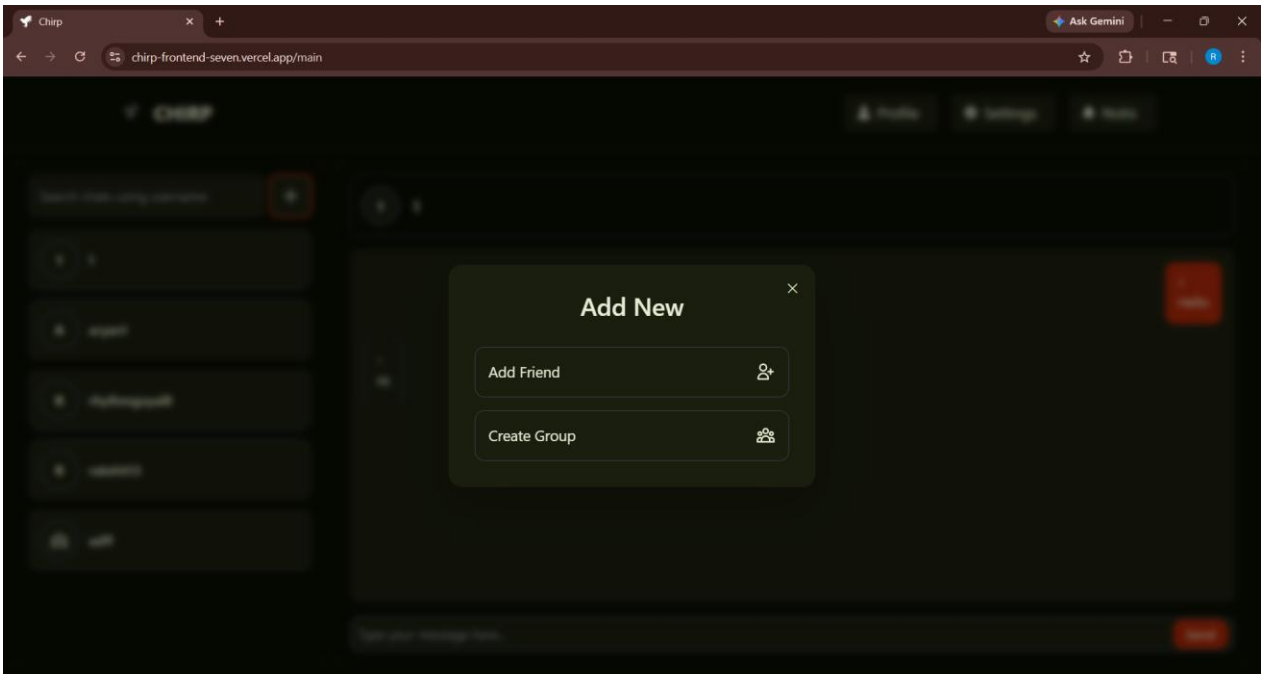

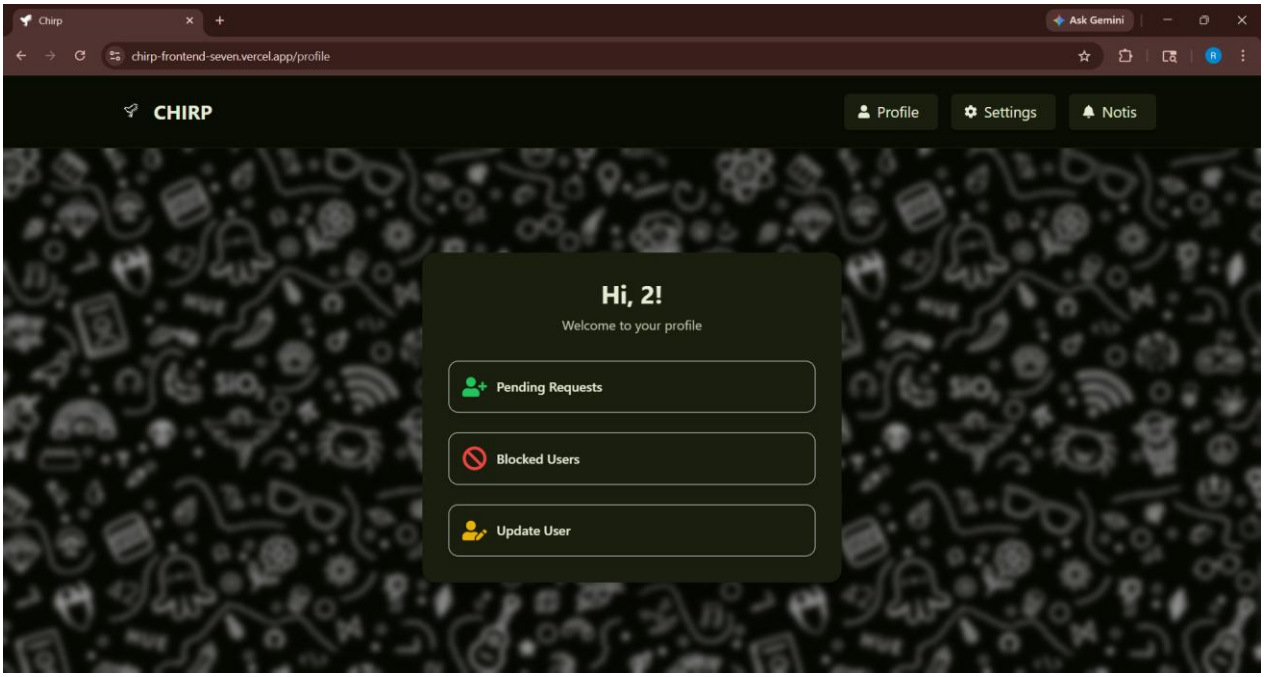

Source code available at https://github.com/rishabhdevKaushik/Chirp